

Martin Newkirk

Product + Builder | Founder | Clean Energy & Mobility | Ex-Uber

Sydney, NSW (Australian Citizen)

martinnewkirk@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/martin-newkirk-29061120](https://www.linkedin.com/in/martin-newkirk-29061120)

cleanenergyreviews.info | photonik.solar | martinnewkirk.online

SUMMARY

Founder with 10+ years in product and operations across clean energy and transport. Co-founded Photonik, solar design software with 2,100+ installer businesses signed up.

Previously scaled Car Next Door from startup to Uber acquisition, leading product, strategy, and operations. Launched Key Swap, which 60% of the 10,000-car fleet used by the time Uber acquired the business, and rebuilt Photonik with AI in six months.

EXPERIENCE

Photonik

Co-Founder | Product & Operations

2022 – Present | Sydney, NSW

- **Photonik is professional solar design software**, with 2,100+ installer businesses signed up and users in 190+ countries since launch, and a marketplace for homeowners to buy solar from installers
- **Rebuilt the platform** with AI-assisted development (Claude, Cursor) in six months, then shipped 10 new core features in weekly releases
- Own the product roadmap, sprint planning and delivery
- Run in-product feedback (Net Promoter Score +51 from installers, +33 from homeowners) and use it to set the roadmap

Uber Carshare (previously Car Next Door)

Senior Associate, Strategy & Operations

Sep 2021 – Sep 2024 | Hybrid – Sydney, NSW

- Spent 2024 as Policy, Safety & Risk Programs Lead, owning the vehicle safety policy overhaul during the Uber integration
- Ran company OKR planning and monthly executive reviews through the Uber acquisition and rebrand, aligned with Uber's global teams
- Launched the complaints reporting system, with analytics and frontline training, so the business met AFCA requirements
- Built the EV program dashboards and partnered with Growth and Product on campaigns that increased EV supply

Product Manager

Apr 2018 – Sep 2021

- Launched Key Swap so owners could join without a full in-car installation. By the Uber acquisition, 10,000 cars were on the platform and 60% used Key Swap
 - Reworked onboarding and trip start to make bookings more reliable and cut cancellations
 - Ran A/B tests on checkout so more new users completed a first trip
 - As Car Next Door's first product manager, set up agile delivery and quarterly OKRs from scratch
-

Fleet Manager

Mar 2016 – Mar 2018

- Managed sales and operations teams to onboard new vehicles nationwide
- Launched Brisbane and quadrupled weekly installs
- Optimised fleet utilisation and reduced operational costs

Clean Energy Reviews

Founder

2014 – Present

- Built an independent solar and battery advice site with 8.3M unique visitors and 10.2M visits (2014–2025)

Newkirk Solar Services

Founder

Apr 2012 – Mar 2016 | Melbourne, VIC

- Founded and managed solar operations business, overseeing logistics, administration, and installations
- Built a system that automated quotes, invoices and compliance paperwork (including STC forms) for electricians entering solar

Shine On

Operations Manager

Feb 2011 – May 2012 | Melbourne, VIC

- Managed supply chain, procurement, and logistics for solar installation business
- Streamlined internal processes and supplier management to improve efficiency

UK Department of Health

Business Manager

Jan 2009 – Aug 2010 | London, UK

- Supported Director General of Informatics with ministerial briefings and strategic documentation

EDUCATION

Master of Commerce — RMIT (2012, 5 units completed)

Bachelor of International Studies — International Relations & Asian Studies — Flinders University (2003 – 2007)

University Exchange, Political Science — Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile (2006)

University Exchange, Bahasa Indonesia — Universitas Gadjah Mada (2005)

High School Diploma — Adelaide High School (1997 – 2001)

INTERESTS

Strongroom Cricket Club | 2009 – Present

Dulwich Hill PS Parents and Citizens Association (P&C) | President 2024

Rock Climbing | Running | Tennis | Husband and Dad

SKILLS

Core: Product Management, Business Operations, Product Operations, Strategic Planning, People Management, Data Analysis, Agile Methodologies, AI-Assisted Development

LANGUAGES

English: Native/Bilingual

Spanish: Limited Working

Indonesian: Elementary